



PAPUA

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 1 MAY 2026 - 30 MAY 2026

DATA STATUS: MIXED SOURCES (LIVE, MANUAL & STATIC)

LATEST RECORD: 21 MAY 2026

LAST UPDATED: 23 MAY 2026

No relevant incidents were recorded in the 7-day window; this report uses the most recent 30-day context.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Papua (Indonesian West Papua) is a restricted-reporting, high-friction operating environment spanning the six provinces of the Indonesian half of New Guinea. The 30-day window holds 39 records. The current-cycle reporting points to crime / public safety, student activism and security force operation, which is the practical concern for any footprint in the coastal cities or the resource corridors. The 30-day and 90-day context sections widen the lookback to keep highland insurgency, commemoration-date protest cycles and resource-sector exposure in view; treat them as background risk rather than live events. Reporting access in Papua is genuinely constrained, so the headline count should not be read as a measure of risk.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 1 May - 30 May 2026	TOTAL RECORDS 39 Incidents in window	HIGHEST SEVERITY Extreme Worst rating in window
MOST AFFECTED AREA Multiple locations	LATEST INCIDENT 21 May 2026	MAIN ISSUE TYPE Other operational incident 17 records

SITUATION

Papua is shaped by a long-running low-intensity insurgency, recurring student and church-led protest over Jakarta's security and resource policy, heavy TNI/POLRI deployment across the highlands, and extreme geographic isolation. The 7-day window held no fresh records, so this read draws on the most recent 30-day window. The 30-day window holds 39 records. Treat these as the active operational signal. Jayapura and Wamena carry the clearest operational signal this cycle. Records beyond the last 30 days sit in the 90-day background section below and should be read as deeper context.

WHAT HAPPENED

The most recent 30-day window points to crime / public safety, student activism and security force operation in or around Jayapura. That is the active signal. Anything beyond this week — student protest cycles, highland clashes and TPNPB-OPM activity, Freeport convoy security and cross-border movement on the PNG frontier — sits in the 30 / 90-day context sections and should be read as background pattern rather than current activity.

WHAT MATTERS

The pattern is broad enough to act on. Jayapura and Wamena carry the clearest operational signal this cycle. Use it to prioritise journey management, site-access checks and pre-movement coordination in the affected sub-regions before broader posture changes.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Confirm Surat Jalan / travel-permit status before any movement into the highlands; access can be withdrawn at short notice during security operations.
- Plan highland and interior travel by air via Sentani, Timika, Wamena, Manokwari or Sorong; treat road movement on the Trans-Papua corridor as weather- and security-dependent.
- Hold heightened journey management around Jayapura and Manokwari campuses and government sites on commemoration dates (1 May, 1 December, 19 December) and during student protest cycles.
- For resource-sector footprints, confirm convoy security and TNI/POLRI and contracted-security coordination on the Timika-Tembagapura (Freeport) and Bintuni Bay (Tangguh LNG) corridors.
- Build in tolerance for internet shutdowns and cellular blackspots; carry HF/VHF or satellite comms for highland and interior work.
- Confirm out-of-province medevac arrangements (Makassar / Jakarta / Singapore); in-province tier-1 care is not available and highland evacuation is weather-dependent.
- Treat thin weekly reporting as restricted access, not low risk; cross-check local-language and church / NGO sources before standing down posture.

LOCATION WATCHLIST

LOCATION	NOTE	7D	30D	90D	WORST (90D)
Jayapura	Provincial capital, university protest focal point	0	7	24	HIGH
Sorong	Southwest Papua, LNG and port hub	0	4	8	MODERATE
Manokwari	West Papua capital, Tangguh corridor	0	2	4	MODERATE
Timika / Mimika (Freeport belt)	Grasberg copper-gold corridor, armed-group threat to convoys	0	4	11	EXTREME
Wamena (Baliem Valley)	Highland Papua, weather-dependent access	0	4	11	EXTREME
Nduga / Intan Jaya / Puncak	Active TPNPB-OPM operating area	0	7	18	EXTREME
Merauke	South Papua agribusiness corridor	0	2	2	LOW
Nabire	Central Papua, coastal staging point	0	0	1	LOW
PNG border districts	Keerom / Pegunungan Bintang / Boven Digoel cross-border movement	0	0	0	No records
Highlands airstrips	Sentani (DJJ), Timika (TIM), Sorong (SOQ), Manokwari (MKW), Wamena (WMX)	0	5	17	EXTREME
Trans-Papua highway corridor	Partially built, wet-season landslide closures	0	0	0	No records

30-DAY CONTEXT

Across the rolling 30-day context window Papua carries 39 records, with 39 records sitting outside the current 7-day cycle.

BACKGROUND OPERATING PICTURE

Across the rolling 90-day background window Papua carries 102 records, 63 of which sit beyond the 30-day context. Use them to size the background operating picture rather than to direct current movement decisions.

MAP



● Extreme

● High

● Moderate

● Low

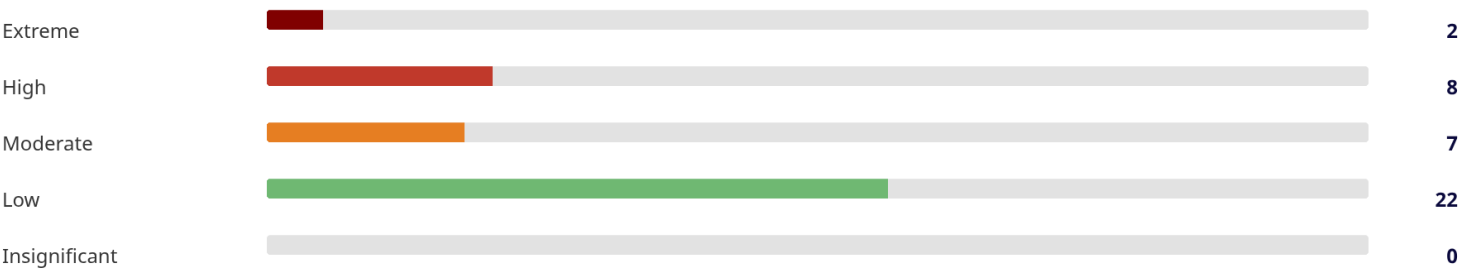
● Insignificant

Leaflet | (c) OpenStreetMap (c) CARTO

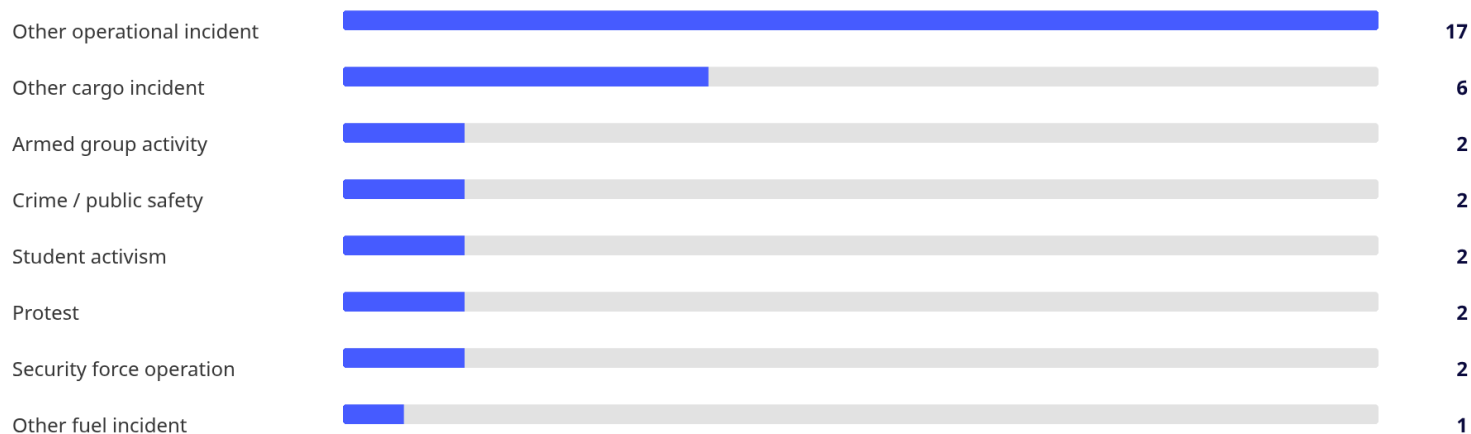
Records without coordinates are included in totals and tables but not plotted on the map. 20 of 39 records excluded from the map.

The map reflects the active reporting window — 39 30-day records. It is not the full risk picture — read it alongside the 30 / 90-day context sections above.

SEVERITY DISTRIBUTION



INCIDENT BREAKDOWN BY TYPE



WATCH NEXT

- Renewed student or church-led protest out of Jayapura, Manokwari or Sorong, especially around commemoration dates.
- TNI/POLRI security operations or TPNPB-OPM clashes in Nduga, Intan Jaya, Puncak, Puncak Jaya or Yahukimo.
- Armed-group activity or convoy incidents on the Timika–Tembagapura (Freeport Grasberg) corridor.
- Labour or indigenous-rights friction around the Tangguh LNG / Bintuni Bay belt and South Papua plantation concessions.
- Highland access disruption — landslide closures on the Trans-Papua corridor, weather-grounded airstrips or operation-driven district lockdowns.
- Internet or communications shutdowns imposed in response to unrest.
- Cross-border movement or refugee flows on the Keerom / Pegunungan Bintang / Boven Digoel frontier with Papua New Guinea.

POLESTAR VIEW

Papua should be treated as a restricted-reporting, high-friction operating environment. A quiet week does not equal low risk. The current incidents point to crime / public safety, student activism and security force operation, while the 30 / 90-day context keeps highland insurgency, protest cycles and resource-corridor exposure in view. Business users should focus on permit and movement discipline, air-first highland travel, resilient communications and clear out-of-province medevac triggers.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	TYPE	TITLE	SEVERITY
21 May 2026 00:00	Other cargo incident	Kekerasan HAM Berat Papua Meningkat, SRP: Hentikan Operasi Militer!	LOW
20 May 2026 00:00	Other cargo incident	Pemenuhan SDM nakes merupakan kebutuhan mendesak di Papua Tengah	LOW
20 May 2026 00:00	Other cargo incident	Pemprov Papua percepat penanganan infrastruktur di Kabupaten Kepulauan Yapen	LOW
20 May 2026 00:00	Other cargo incident	Gubernur Fakhiri prioritaskan perbaikan jalur barat dan pengembangan bandara Yapen	LOW
19 May 2026 00:00	Other cargo incident	Masa Bongkar Semakin Panjang, PT SPIL Bongkar Kontainer di Timika	LOW
19 May 2026 00:00	Other cargo incident	Pemkot Diminta Bantu Fasilitas Penyelesaian Masalah di Perum Organda	LOW
19 May 2026 00:00	Other fuel incident	PNG CORE applauds PM Marape's leadership on fuel subsidy and industry dialogue	LOW
19 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	TPNPB claims retaliatory attack killed 1 Indonesian soldier in Yahukimo after 2 fighters die	HIGH
18 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Intan Jaya regent calls for protection of civilians after church compound shooting	MODERATE
18 May 2026 00:00	Clash	Two TPNPB fighters killed in clash; group claims retaliatory killing of one soldier in Yahukimo	MODERATE
14 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	TNI-TPNPB armed contact in Sugapa and Hitadipa leaves civilians wounded	EXTREME
12 May 2026 00:00	Strike / labour action	Manokwari trader rally over market relocation	LOW
12 May 2026 00:00	Armed group activity	IED found at Wamena district office checkpoint	HIGH
11 May 2026 00:00	Crime / public safety	Industrial-zone warehouse theft in Sorong	LOW
11 May 2026 00:00	Armed robbery	Money-changer holdup in central Jayapura	MODERATE
11 May 2026 00:00	Warehouse theft	Industrial-zone warehouse theft in Sorong, Polres investigating organised crew	MODERATE
10 May 2026 00:00	Student activism	Cenderawasih University student march over autonomy bill	MODERATE
10 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Firefight near Sugapa, Intan Jaya regency	HIGH
09 May 2026 00:00	Protest	Mine-affected community protest blocks Timika road	MODERATE

08 May 2026 00:00	Security force operation	Five civilians killed in Indonesian military operation at Kali Kabur gold panning area	HIGH
08 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Office break-in at Jayapura business district	LOW
08 May 2026 00:00	Security force operation	TPNPB raid on contractor camp in Nduga	HIGH
07 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Brief firefight between TPNPB and TNI patrol north of Wamena	HIGH
07 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Five civilians shot dead in Tembagapura mining area	EXTREME
06 May 2026 00:00	Armed group activity	TPNPB ambush of TNI patrol on Wamena ring road	HIGH
05 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	@lolitarsta22586: Kontak Tembak Memanas, OPM Lau Gwijangge Tumbang #KomandanOPMLauGwijanggeTewas Selasa Pagii Sarapan Arsenal Ilham https://t.co/d6oVp8aVdA	LOW
05 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	@pelindo_reg4: Greetings #Portizen Pelindo Regional 4 Synergy - DPRD, Driving Sorong Port Development	LOW
05 May 2026 00:00	Crime / public safety	Police shoot seven students during graduation parade over Morning Star flag display	HIGH
05 May 2026 00:00	Student activism	Cenderawasih University students rally on tuition adjustment	MODERATE
04 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	From Pepera to Military Operations, KNPB: 63 Years of Papua's Endless Suffering.	LOW
04 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Pelindo-DPRD accelerate Sorong Port to become logistics hub in KTI	LOW
03 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	TNI Neutralizes OPM Operation Commander Jeki Murib in Central Papua.	LOW
03 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	TNI Neutralizes OPM Operations Commander Jeki Murib in Central Papua	LOW
02 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Discussion and Evaluation of Manokwari and Merauke Port Master Plan by Pelindo Regional 4 Executive Director	LOW
02 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	@Ceker_Ayam_: (Agustus, 2019) Terjadi kasus rasisme di daerah JaTim kepada mahasiswa timur, salah satu diantaranya dikatakan monyet. Efeknya? Hampir seb...	LOW
01 May 2026 00:00	Protest	Women's Demonstration: United Papua Women Reject PSN and Militarism	LOW
01 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	Yahukimo News: Brief Info from Dekai City, Arrest of 2 Students from State Elementary School 1 Dekai, Yahukimo in Emergency State of Citizen Arrests	LOW
01 May 2026 00:00	Other operational incident	KNPB: Stop Military Operations and Troop Deployment in Papua Land	LOW
01 May 2026 00:00	Crackdown	Murder of Democratic Space by Indonesian Police Against Papua Community Demonstrations, Closing Democratic Space, Water Cannon Shooting	LOW

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